



江苏省苏州中学国际部
Suzhou High School – International Division

SZZX-ID BP Physics

Force on a current carrying wire

Class Outline

Title of Unit	Introduction to magnetic field
Title of Lesson	Force on a current carrying wire
Starter Activity	Kahoot: Magnetism and magnetic field
Direct Instructions	Teaching Strategies: Demonstration, Lecture, Collaboration, Questioning, Inquiry
	- demonstration: force between wires - lecture: left-hand rule - inquiry: worksheet
	Differentiation: Content, Instructional Strategies, the Classroom, Products, Teacher
	- work on worksheet as pairs - Group discussion for the last questions (challenge yourselves)
	International Mindedness:
Lesson Objectives	By the end of the lesson, students will be able to: - Understand the strength and direction of magnetic force on a current-carrying wire - Understand and predict force between two wires - Apply left-hand rule to determine the direction of the force - Understand and explain motor effect – speaker and motor
ATLs	Identify unit ATLs and how they are being addressed in the lesson
	Thinking: Being curious about the natural world (how things work: motor and speaker)
IB Learner Profile	Link the lesson to the characteristics of the IB Learner attribute
	Inquirer, thinker
Teaching Activities	- demonstration: video: force on a wire; force between two wires - worksheet: left hand rule
Plenary Session	Checking for understanding / Homework / Q & A / Reflection etc.

Magnetic Field Strength, B



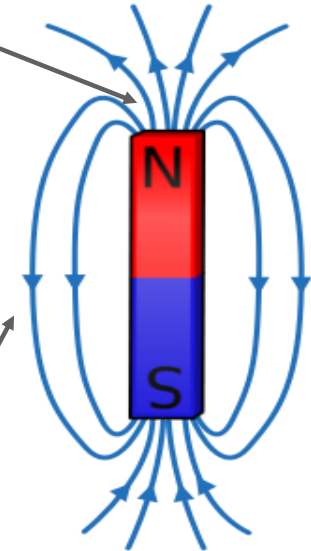
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The magnetic field strength, B , can be thought of as the **density of magnetic field lines per square meter** (also called Magnetic Flux Density, B).

It is a **vector**.

It has units of **Tesla, T**.

The density of flux lines is great, therefore B is large.



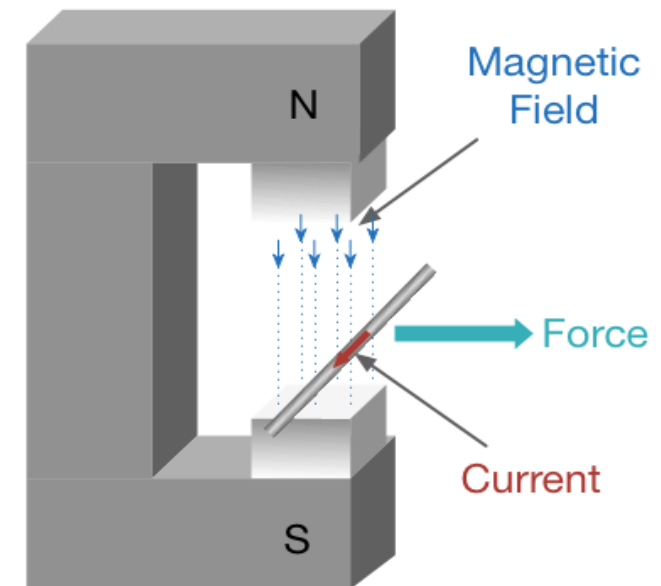
The density of flux lines is small, therefore B is small.

The Magnetic Force on Current



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- If a current-carrying wire is placed in a region of magnetic field, it will experience a magnetic force.
- The magnitude of force is maximized when the current is **perpendicular to the magnetic field**.
- The force is 0 when the current is **parallel to the magnetic field**.



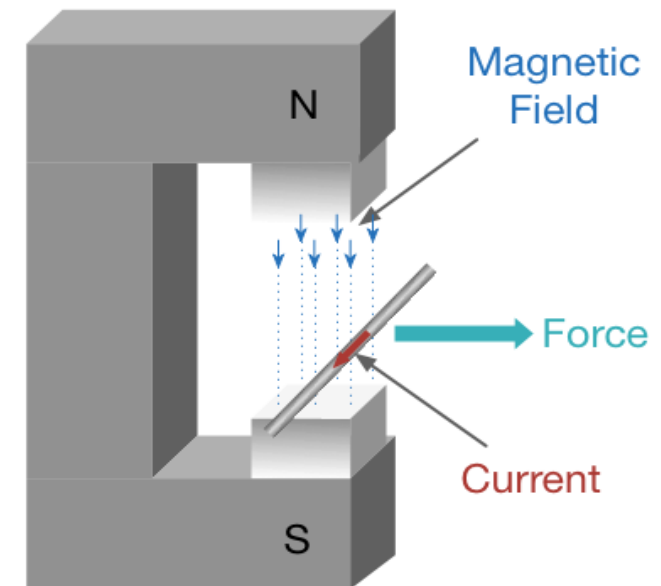
The Magnetic Force on Current



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To increase the magnitude of the force

- Increase the current in the wire.
- Increase the strength of the magnetic field.
- Increase the length of the wire within the magnetic field.
- Increase the number of wires

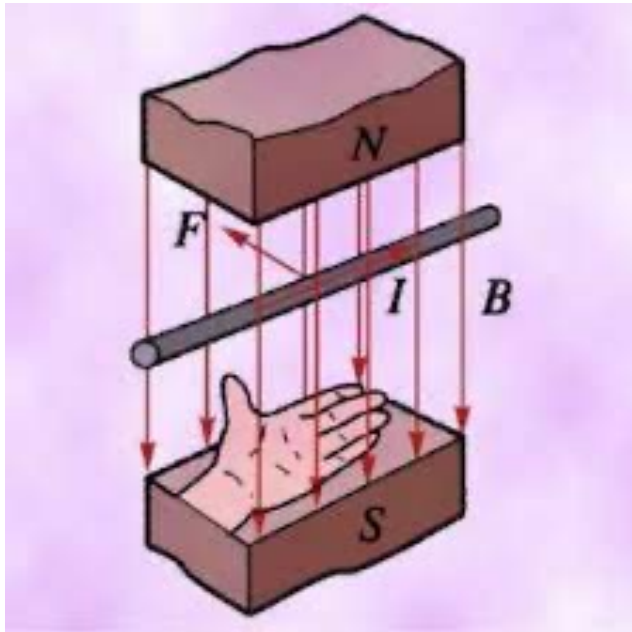


Determine the direction of magnetic force on a straight wire



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Left-hand rule



- Use **left hand**
- Let **magnetic field lines** go into the palm
- The **four fingers** pointing to the direction of **current**
- The **direction of the thumb** is the direction of **magnetic force** acting on the wire

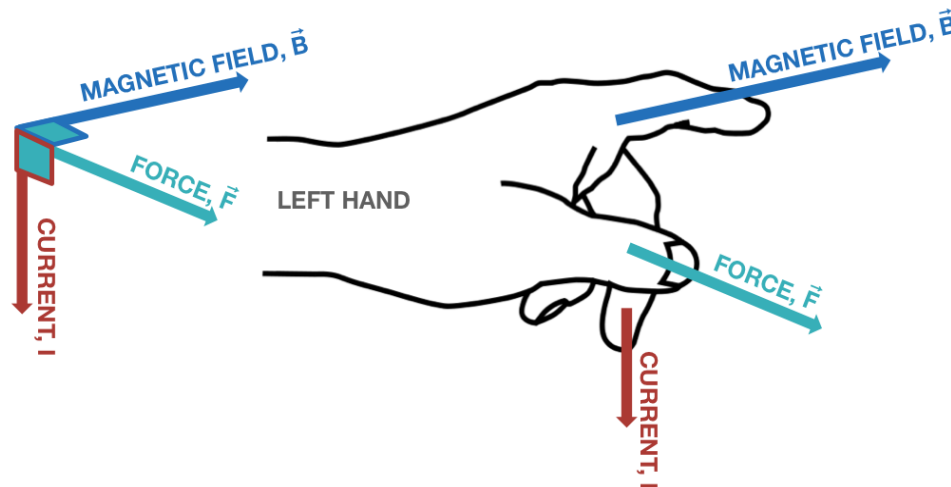
Determine the direction of magnetic force on a straight wire – another way



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Fleming's Left Hand Rule

The **direction of the magnetic force** can be determined using Fleming's Left Hand Rule.

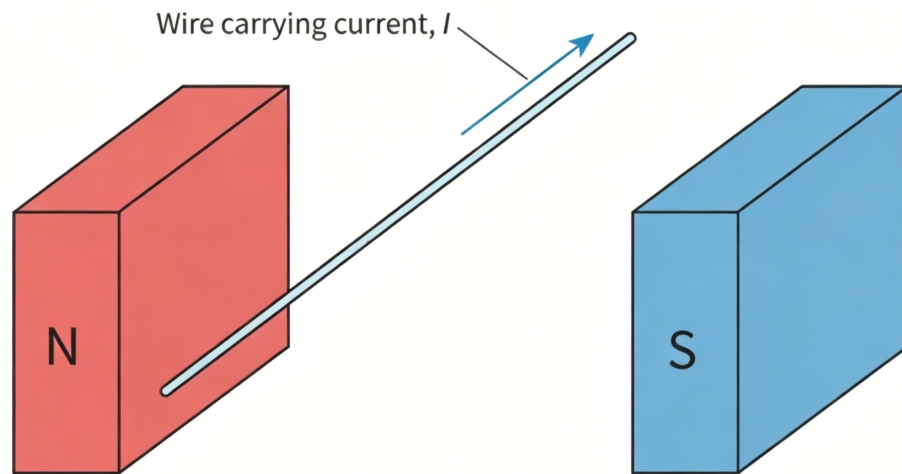


All three fingers should be mutually perpendicular.

Practice – left hand rule



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Choose your preferred left-hand rule and determine the direction of force.

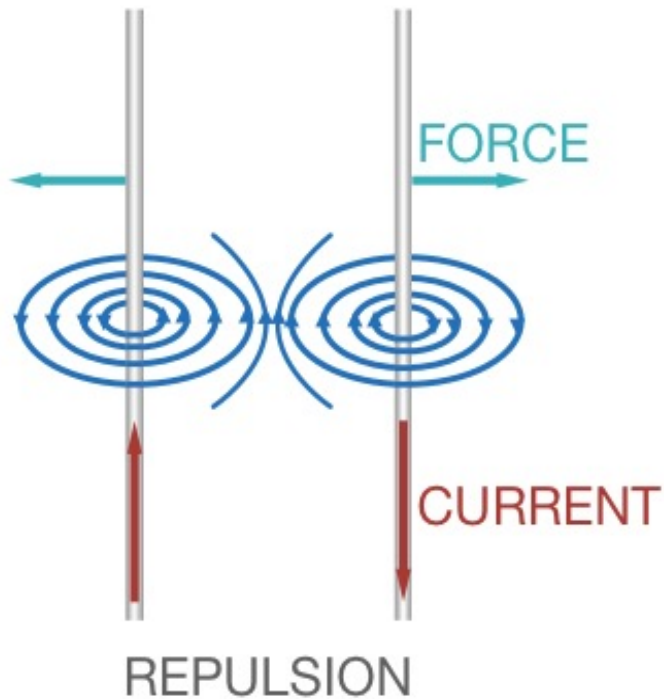
Remember they are just tools. You just need to pick one and get familiar with it

- Field: left to right
- Current: into the page
- Force: down
- If either the current or the field are reversed, the force will be upwards.

Magnetic Force Between Two Wires



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Two current-carrying wires brought close to each other will experience a force.

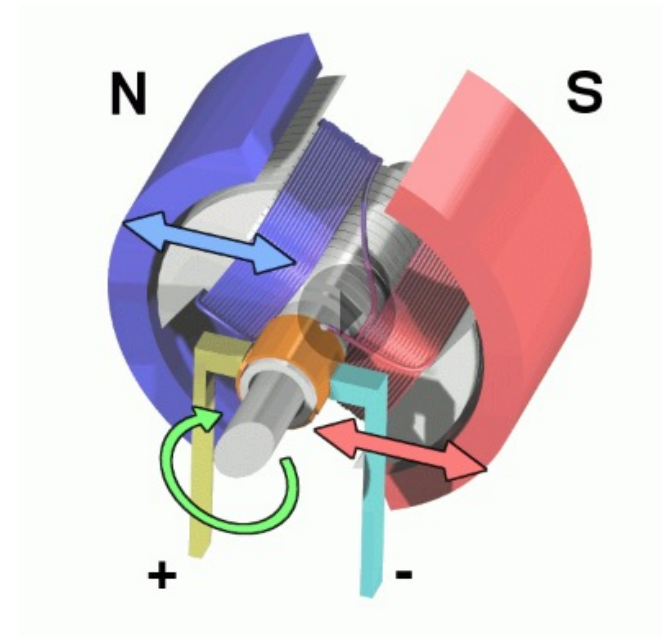
- Opposing currents produce a repulsive force.
- Like currents produce an attractive force.

The D.C. motor



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- Electric motors are incredibly reliable. They only have one moving part and can spin very slowly or very quickly without the use of gears.
- Applications include lifts, washing machines, trains, blenders, robots, drones and even cars.



Source: 'Electric motor' by Abnormal, [CC-BY-SA-3.0](#)

The D.C. motor

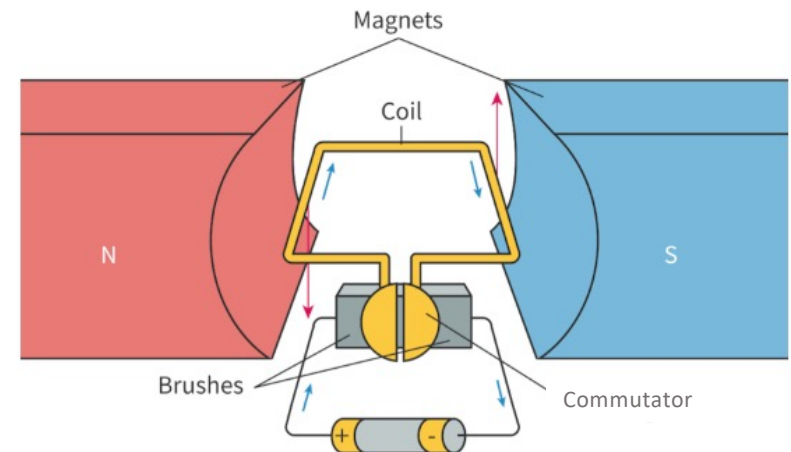


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- The left-hand side of the coil is perpendicular to the magnetic field and therefore experiences a force downwards.
- The right arm of the coil is carrying current in the opposite direction and is also perpendicular to the magnetic field, and so experiences a force upwards.
- A turning force causes the coil to spin about the pivot.

To increase the turning force of a motor, you can:

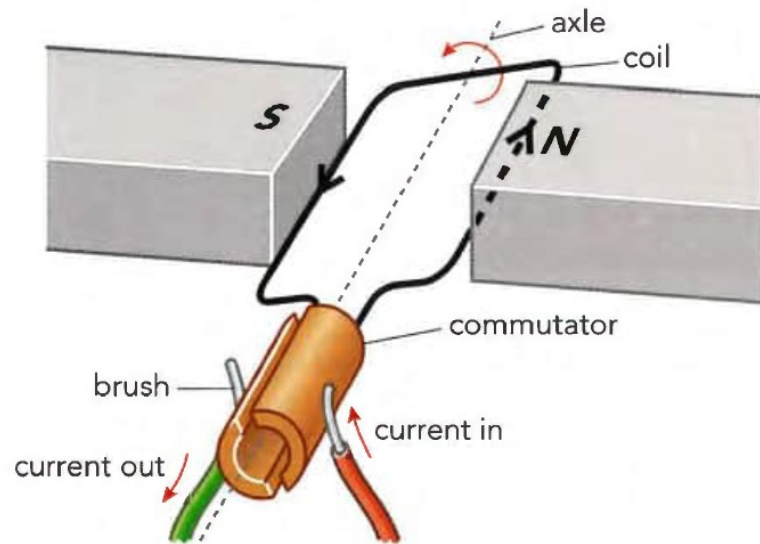
- increase the current
- increase the strength of the magnetic field
- increase the number of turns in the coil.



Keeping the motor turning



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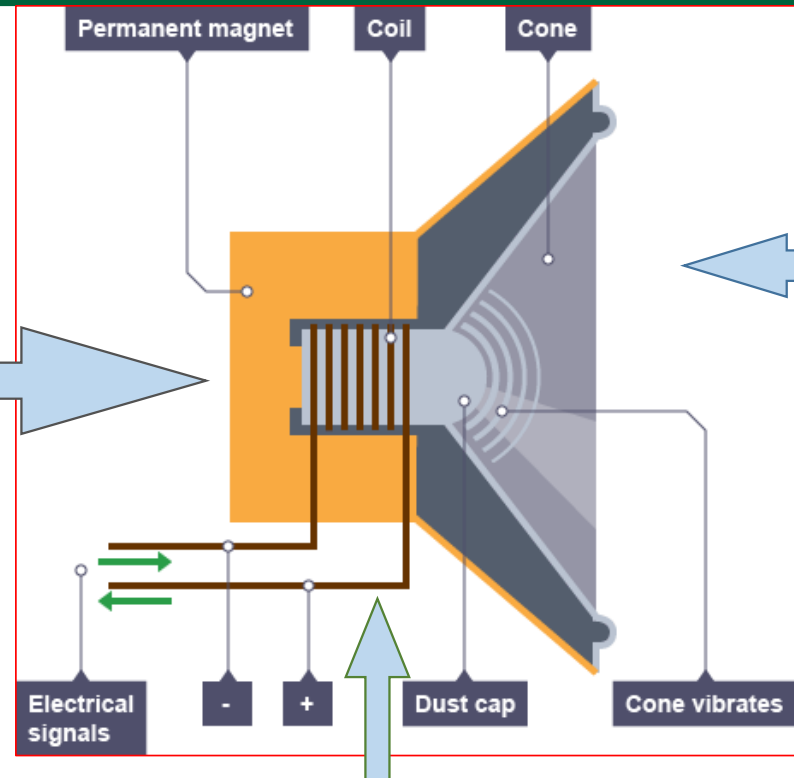
Each half-turn, the commutator reverses the connections to the power supply, so that the motor keeps turning in the same direction

The loudspeaker



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1. The cylindrical magnet produces a strong radial magnetic field at **right angles** to the wire in the coil, which is **attached** to a paper or plastic cone.



3. The speaker cone also moves back and forth in response to the electrical signal, generating sound waves.

2. When a current flows in the wire, the wire and cone will move. The current input carries with the sound being produced- a varying signal received from a sound processing device (e.g. a computer)